



Ask ONE

# Answers from trusted ONE guidance

Help customers find useful answers and reach the right service.

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Project proposal: first MVP

# Finding guidance should lead to a clear next step

We want to test whether customers can reach useful ONE guidance more easily by asking a question.

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## The journey to investigate

### “Which guide applies to my question?”

A customer may need to search several pages, interpret the guidance and decide which service to use next.

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## The experience we propose

### An answer, its source and a useful next step

Ask ONE would explain approved guidance and link to the relevant ONE service when the task needs more information.

Discovery will test this opportunity against existing search and help journeys. ONE customer demand and benefits are still unmeasured.

# Ask ONE would explain guidance and help customers act

A customer asks a question in everyday English. Ask ONE would explain approved public ONE guidance and show where to read more.

|               |                                                               |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01 Ask        | Ask one question about a supported public topic.              |
| 02 Understand | Read a short explanation of the relevant guidance.            |
| 03 Check      | Open the original ONE page or document to check the details.  |
| 04 Continue   | Follow a link to the relevant ONE service or support channel. |

If the approved content cannot support an answer, Ask ONE should say so and offer guidance or support instead of guessing.

The first release does not access accounts, provide live tracking or shipment-specific answers, or complete bookings and transactions.

# A useful answer with a source the customer can open

## Ask ONE

Illustrative example

**Where can I find shipping instructions guidance?**

Open the Shipping Instructions guide for the submission steps. For details about your own shipment, continue in ONE eCommerce.

### EXAMPLE SOURCE

#### Shipping Instructions guide

The answer would link to the supporting section.

Open guide

ONE eCommerce

## Explain the guidance

Use approved public content to answer the question in plain English.

## Make the source visible

Let the customer check the guidance and read further.

## Point to the next action

Open ONE eCommerce for shipment-specific tasks. Ask ONE does not carry them out.

Illustrative wording and source label. This is not verified shipping advice or a live Ask ONE service.

# Why this could help customers and ONE

The opportunity is to make routine guidance easier to use and help customers reach the right service.

| For ONE customers                                                                                                             | For ONE                                                                                                                                |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div><b>Less effort finding answers</b></div> <div>Understand relevant guidance without piecing together several pages.</div> | <div><b>More useful public content</b></div> <div>Help customers use the guidance ONE already publishes.</div>                         |
| <div><b>A clearer next step</b></div> <div>Find the service that fits the task more easily.</div>                             | <div><b>Better routes to digital services</b></div> <div>Reduce avoidable navigation and misdirected enquiries.</div>                  |
| <div><b>Help with routine questions</b></div> <div>Read an explanation and check its original source.</div>                   | <div><b>Potentially fewer repetitive enquiries</b></div> <div>Leave more room for support to handle issues that need human help.</div> |

These are expected benefits, not measured results. Visible sources help customers check an answer but do not guarantee accuracy.

# Ask Maersk offers a pattern worth testing for ONE

Personal research from August 2026 provides examples of the experience. It does not establish ONE customer demand.

## What the recordings show

Answers explain shipping topics and surface related content.

A schedule-related response refers customers to official tools or local offices.

Some recorded turns are incomplete.

## What ONE still needs to prove

Can approved ONE content support accurate, useful answers?

Do service links help customers complete their next step?

Does the proposed experience work reliably on representative ONE questions?

The benchmark informs our design questions. It does not prove answer correctness, production reliability or a business return.

# What the first release will include

## A focused customer service

### 01 Answers from approved guidance

Short explanations with sources customers can open.

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### 02 Links to the relevant service

Help customers find their next step and give feedback.

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### 03 Content and quality controls

Keep sources current, review answers and monitor the service.

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## First MVP boundary

**English only**

**Public ONE content**

**One question at a time**

No customer sign-in is needed.

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**Outside this release:** more languages, account or shipment data, transactions, follow-up conversation and complex integrations.

MVP means minimum viable product. Discovery defines the first journey and content. The proof of concept (PoC) tests feasibility before the build.

# A provisional nine-month path to the first release

Proposed project scope: deliver the first MVP, with scope, cost and schedule reviewed after the PoC.

| Period     | Focus                     | Proposed milestone                                      |
|------------|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Month 1    | Discovery                 | Initial scope, permitted sample and PoC proposal        |
| Month 2    | Bounded PoC               | Reassess scope, costs and the remaining schedule        |
| Months 3–4 | Core development          | Working preview in Month 4                              |
| Months 5–6 | Hardening                 | Manager demo in Month 6                                 |
| Month 7    | Limited user pilot        | Evidence from a controlled audience and content set     |
| Month 8    | Target production release | Controlled rollout if readiness criteria pass           |
| Month 9    | Stabilization             | Monitor use, fix priority issues and improve operations |

Months run from discovery kickoff and assume timely decisions and content readiness. Evaluation and security begin during discovery and continue throughout the project.

# Content readiness can significantly move the schedule

PO/PPO and content owners need to agree which guidance is useful, resolve gaps and approve it for the intended audience.

## Before the PoC

A representative sample with permission for testing must be available.

## Before the pilot

The minimum useful content set must be approved and current.

## If sources are late

Consider fewer approved topics. If the minimum set is missing, revise the dates.

## Separate readiness reviews

**Before the Month 7 pilot:** review test evidence, approved sources, monitoring and safe fallback.

**Before the Month 8 release:** confirm pilot results, content readiness and operational support.

The manager demo is a progress milestone. Release depends on quality, security and reliability evidence.

Missed criteria require a revised forecast, which may extend beyond Month 9. Stabilization still follows the actual release.

# Potential extensions after the first release

|                                    |                                                                                      |
|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>More languages</b>              | Ask questions and receive guidance in additional languages.                          |
| <b>eCommerce integrations</b>      | Retrieve current schedules or shipment information through authorized services.      |
| <b>Other ONE services</b>          | Connect with additional ONE services to help customers complete more tasks.          |
| <b>Forms integration</b>           | Help prepare enquiry or service-request forms for customer review before submission. |
| <b>Signed-in customer features</b> | See information relevant to the customer's account and permitted shipments.          |
| <b>Follow-up questions</b>         | Clarify a question and continue the same task without starting again.                |
| <b>Connected customer support</b>  | Share an unresolved question and relevant context with support, with consent.        |

These options sit outside the nine-month estimate. Priorities and dates depend on customer demand, feasibility and separate approval.

# What success would look like

Compare Ask ONE with existing search and help on the same customer questions.

| Outcome to test             | Evidence to collect                                                           |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Useful, correct guidance    | Reviewed answers, working sources and the right next action.                  |
| Less customer effort        | Time to useful guidance, task completion and customer feedback.               |
| Fewer routine support needs | Resolution of supported questions and whether customers still need help.      |
| Acceptable operating cost   | Cost per successful answer, including content maintenance and support effort. |

Discovery defines the comparison. The PoC informs scope and cost. The limited pilot tests customer outcomes before production release.

Budget and return remain unfinalized. A source click or an abandoned session does not prove successful resolution.

## TECHNICAL FOCUS

# How the proposed service would work

Architecture, source management, security and evaluation provide the evidence behind the delivery decision.

The following designs are proposals to validate during the PoC and later readiness testing.

# Retrieve approved guidance, then compose a checked answer

Use the proposed Google Cloud platform direction while keeping source selection and response controls in the application.



## Application on GKE

Google Kubernetes Engine hosts the web experience and APIs that enforce request and source rules.



## Retrieve source passages

Retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) supplies relevant approved content. Cloud SQL with pgvector is an initial option.



## Gemini through Vertex AI

Managed inference composes the answer. The application checks source support and citations before returning it.

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## What the PoC must establish

Can this approach retrieve the right passages and produce useful answers within an acceptable response time and cost? Compare it with ordinary search before fixing component choices.

Cloudflare remains the proposed edge. Cloud Storage keeps source versions. Live customer-data APIs are future options.

# Every answer needs a source that can be updated or removed

Retain the source link, owner and version through extraction and retrieval so content changes can reach the answer service.

| Stage               | Proposed behavior                                                              | Evidence to collect in the PoC                                       |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Collect and approve | Use permitted English public content. Keep drafts and restricted material out. | Can the sample support the chosen customer questions?                |
| Prepare and index   | Extract useful passages with source IDs, versions and links.                   | Do tables, attachments and duplicates affect retrieval or citations? |
| Review and publish  | Evaluate candidate content and record approval before release.                 | Can a reviewed version reproduce the expected answers?               |
| Update and remove   | Synchronize Drupal changes and retire obsolete index and cache entries.        | Does a changed or removed source stop serving stale guidance?        |

The PoC tests a sample lifecycle. Production work must validate synchronization at scale, recovery and ongoing maintenance.

# Content review needs a small, traceable workflow

Assess existing tools first. A custom Hub is justified only if the required workflow cannot be met adequately.

## Illustrative review queue

| Source                      | Status            | Next action         |
|-----------------------------|-------------------|---------------------|
| Shipping Instructions guide | Update staged     | Review the changes  |
| Older guidance version      | Removal requested | Retire from answers |
| Current public guide        | Approved          | View review history |

Example entries show a proposed workflow, not live records.

## Minimum capability

See source status and approval.

Handle updates and removals.

Keep review and release history.

## PoC question

Can existing tools support this workflow and demonstrate traceable changes to the answer service?

# The application controls what can enter an answer

Public access still needs source restrictions, protected administration and controls against unsafe inputs and outputs.

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## Before retrieval

Validate the request, enforce limits and select only approved public sources.

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## During generation

Treat retrieved text as untrusted input. Keep restricted content outside the model context.

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## Before the response

Check citations and source support, apply output screening and fall back to permitted guidance or support.

## Test from the PoC onward

Try restricted documents, malicious instructions, unsupported answers and screening failures.

Model Armor is a candidate input/output screening layer. Test false positives and response-time impact.

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Later readiness testing must validate access enforcement, privacy handling and recovery under load.

# Test the evidence, the answer and the customer's next step

## One reviewed test case

**"Where can I find shipping instructions guidance?"**

### Expected source

The current approved guide and a working citation.

### Expected answer

Explain only what the source supports and link to the relevant next step.

### Failure examples

An invented deadline, a broken citation or a restricted passage.

## Build evidence from the start

Define questions and initial acceptance criteria during discovery. Refine them with PoC findings.

Combine deterministic source/access checks, automated answer evaluation and human judgment.

Ragas and Vertex AI Evaluation are options to assess. Human review checks whether guidance is actually correct and useful.

PoC: compare results with search. Before formal testing: agree thresholds. Pilot: validate outcomes on a defined audience and workload.

# Each request should leave useful evidence for improvement

Record enough context to locate a failure, measure the cost and compare a change with the previous version.

| Observe                                          | Control                                                   | Validate                                                         |
|--------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Response time, errors and completion             | Timeouts, bounded retries and fallback                    | PoC behavior under failure; later load and recovery tests        |
| Model, retrieval, screening and evaluation usage | Token limits, quotas and source-version-aware caching     | Cost per successful answer on an agreed workload                 |
| Source versions, citations and review outcomes   | Trace IDs, redaction, retention and restricted log access | Can a reported issue be traced without excessive sensitive data? |

## Controlled improvement

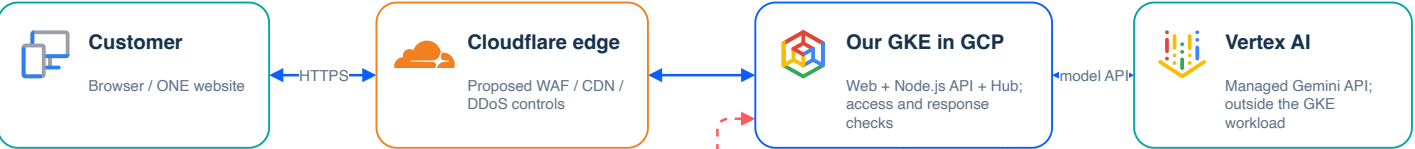
Review feedback, approve a source or application change, repeat the evaluation and compare results. Keep rollback ready. Production monitoring and support readiness remain release conditions.

# Platform architecture

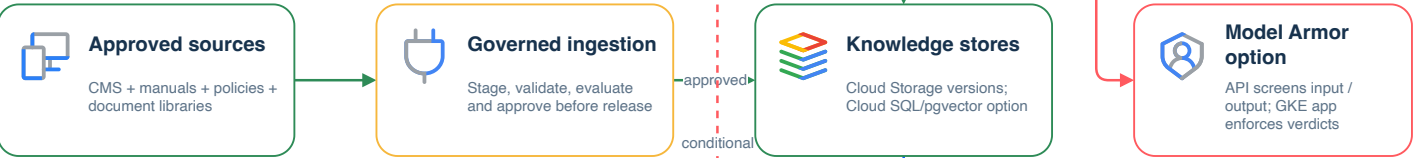
## Ask ONE on our GKE · managed AI through Vertex AI

Proposed delivery design · Phase 1 defines requirements, capacity, access and cost before any build decision

CUSTOMER REQUEST / CHECKED RESPONSE



GOVERNED KNOWLEDGE · PROPOSED STORAGE AND SCREENING OPTIONS



CONDITIONAL LIVE LOOKUPS · OPERATING CONTROLS



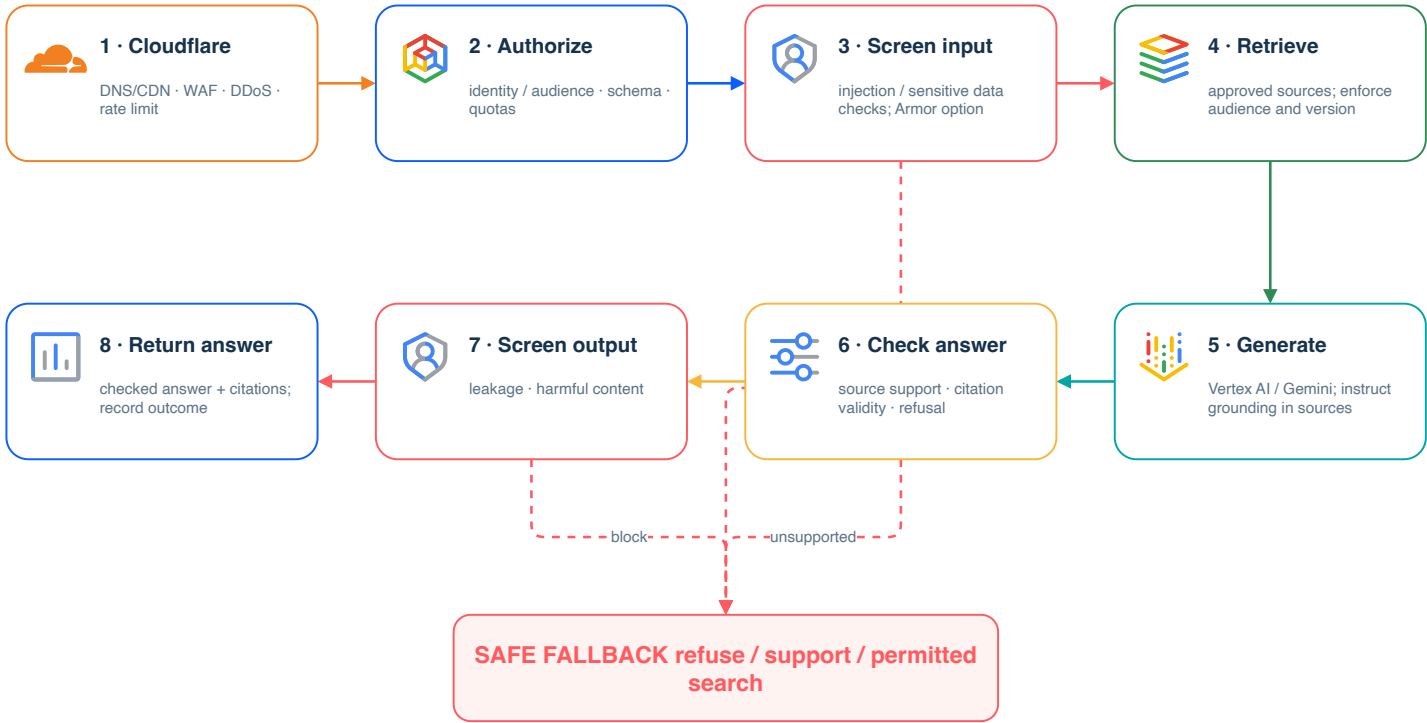
Observability correlates application, retrieval, model and security events across the service.

Proposed components require PoC validation. Conditional live APIs are future options. See Platform direction for the first-release boundary.

# Security flow

## Proposed security flow · enforce controls in the application

Any failed policy check stops the answer; fallback preserves access restrictions. Monitoring covers every stage.



Across all stages: redacted traces, denied access, suspicious activity and alerts to incident owners.

Test enforcement and failure paths during the PoC. Source checks and screening complement each other. See Security controls for the validation approach.

# Knowledge and quality workflow

## Proposed knowledge lifecycle · evaluate before publishing

Keep changes staged until quality, security and owner review approve release. Feedback returns through testing.



Later implementation concept · live operational data uses authorized APIs if justified; no fixed release sequence.

Use the PoC to test a sample update and removal. Production lifecycle automation needs later validation. See Knowledge source lifecycle and Evaluation approach.